

外研社杯·国才杯·2017 年阅读大赛初赛第二场

Questions 1-3 (Suggested completion time: 3 minutes)

Directions: Read the following quotes. Match the quotes with the people. Please note there are two extra options you do not need

A. Winston Churchill	1.At twenty years of age, the will reigns; at thirty, the wit; and at forty, the judgment.
B. Stephen Hawking	
C. Aristotle	2.I have nothing to offer but blood, toil, tears, and sweat.
D. Benjamin Franklin	
E. Hendrik van Loon	3.History is the mighty Tower of Experience, which Time has built amidst the endless fields of bygone ages.

Question 4 (Suggested completion time: 2 minutes)

Directions: *Read the text and answer the question according to the text.*

Effective naps aren't just shorter bouts of deep, nighttime sleep; they're lighter rest periods for the brain. "You don't want to nap too long because you start getting into deeper stages of sleep, and when you wake up from those naps, you feel tired and horrible and cranky," says Grandner, who's an assistant professor of psychiatry, psychology and medicine at the University of Arizona College of Medicine. For Strutner, a 25-year-old *Huffington Post* editor, just 20 minutes did the trick. Afterward, she says, "it's like a whole new day."

4. What is the best title for this text?

- A) Naps Make You Refreshed B) To Nap or Not C) Nap Briefly D) Long Naps Are Exhausting

Question 5 (Suggested completion time: 2 minutes)

Directions: *Read the following book reviews and answer the question.*

" <i>The Elements</i> is a loving reimagination of the classic table." — <i>Wired</i>
"Gray' s trademark dry wit and historical anecdotes bring even the most basic lumps to life." — <i>Popular Science</i>
"A great mix of science and art." — <i>Discover</i>
" <i>The Elements</i> is a photographic tour de force of items from Theo Gray' s personal collection of element samples. If he were to put on a museum show or do a PBS series, this would be the companion book." —Gavin Scott

“Awesome book! Lots of neat facts to read and lots of photos to help with memorization! And the mini poster of the periodic table is a helpful visual tool!” —T.M.

“I don’ t know if this is the first coffee-table book paying lush photographic homage to the periodic table, but it is certainly the most gorgeous one I’ ve seen.” —John Tierney, *The New York Times*

5. What is this book about?

- A) Cookery. B) Architecture. C) Painting. D) Chemistry.

Question 6 (Suggested completion time: 2 minutes)

Directions: *Read the text and answer the question according to the text.*

“We have to think about hibernation and torpor as a continuum rather than discrete things,” agrees Frank van Breukelen. He’ s a biologist at the University of Nevada in Las Vegas.

To scientists like him, torpor and hibernation all start with ***metabolism***. As animals slow their metabolism, body temperatures will drop. Slowing metabolism a little and for just a brief period produces slow-wave sleep. Slow it more and longer and it becomes torpor. Slow it dramatically for prolonged periods and you get hibernation.

The idea of such a hibernation continuum places all mammals on one continuous line. At one end are animals that never go torpid. People fit into this group. At the other end are bears, bats and other animals that may hibernate for months straight.

6. The word ***metabolism*** is closest in meaning to _____.

- A) the rhythmic movement of the body in accordance with the environment C) synthesis of chemical compounds with the aid of radiant energy and especially light
- B) the chemical processes occurring within a living cell or organism that are necessary for the maintenance of life D) the different stages of sleep that overall determine one’ s sleep quality

Question 7 (Suggested completion time: 2 minutes)

Directions: *Read the text and answer the question according to the text.*

In public education, the District of Columbia may be the nation’ s most interesting laboratory. It is the only city with two public school systems of roughly equal size, each with a different governance model. The results of this competition have profound implications for the future of public education nationwide.

The older of the two, the District of Columbia Public Schools, uses the “_____” governance model that emerged more than a century ago, in which the district operates all but one of its 113 schools and employs all the staff, with central control and most policies applied equally to most schools.

7. Which word may probably appear in the blank?

A) comprehensive B) unified C) flexible D) advanced

Question 8 (Suggested completion time: 2 minutes)

Directions: *Read the text and answer the question according to the text.*

Despite entering the fight as an out-of-sight underdog at +425 against the only eight-division champion in the sport's history, Horn surprised most fans by making it through all 12 rounds against Pacquiao—and then shocked everyone minutes later by being declared the winner. Horn landed far fewer punches than his favoured opponent, 93 to Pacquiao's 183, but the judges seemed to reward him for the aggressiveness he showed from the outset of round one.

In no way overwhelmed by the biggest bout of his career in front of 50,000-plus fans at Suncorp Stadium, Horn kept trying to land heavy punches on Pacquiao throughout the match. Despite that, it was Horn who was in serious danger of being declared the loser after a round nine bludgeoning that prompted referee Mark Nelson to tell the Australian's corner that he was prepared to stop the fight if Horn didn't show him something in round 10.

8. Which sport does the text describe?

A) Boxing B) Fencing C) Wrestling D) Shooting

Question 9 (Suggested completion time: 2 minutes)

Directions: *Read the following jokes and answer the question.*

9. Which of the following jokes is different from the other three?

A) When a woman complained to her butcher that his sausage tasted like meat at one end, but like bread at the other, he replied, "Madam, in the times like these, no butcher can make both ends meat."

C) A couple was having a discussion about family finances. Finally the husband exploded, "If it weren't for my money, the house wouldn't be here!" The wife replied, "My dear, if it weren't for your money I wouldn't be here."

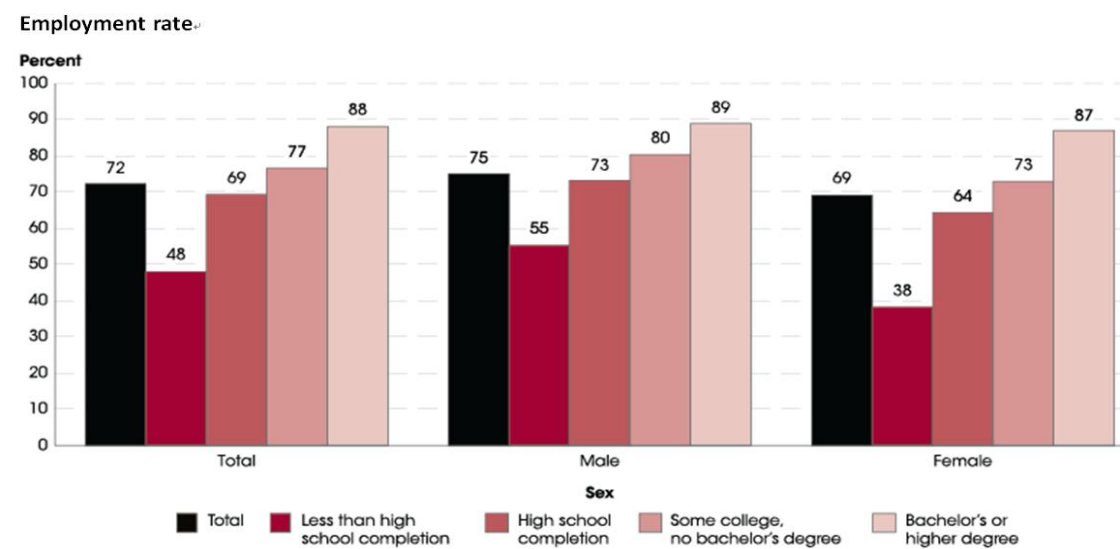
B) Why do elephants have trunks? Because they can't fit everything into a handbag.

D) Almost all the students are talking in the class. The teacher said angrily: "Students, ORDER!" All the students said: "BEER!"

Question 10 (Suggested completion time: 5 minutes)

Directions: *The figure shows the employment rates of 20- to 24-year-olds in the U.S., by sex and educational attainment in 2016. Answer the question according to the information in the*

figure.



SOURCE: U.S. Department of Commerce, Census Bureau, Current Population Survey (CPS), Annual Social and Economic Supplement, March 2016.

10. Which of the following is an INCORRECT description about the figure?

- A) For females, the employment rate without completing high school is more than two times lower compared with the rate for those with a bachelor' s or higher degree.
- B) The difference between the employment rates for females and males becomes larger with the increase in educational attainment.
- C) Among young adults, employment rates are higher for males than for females at each level of educational attainment.
- D) The employment rate is higher for young adults with higher levels of educational attainment than for those with lower levels of educational attainment.

Question 11 (Suggested completion time: 5 minutes)

Directions: Read the definition of the following logical fallacy, and answer the question according to the definition.

Slippery Slope

A *slippery slope* argument attempts to discredit a proposition by arguing that its acceptance will undoubtedly lead to a sequence of events, one or more of which are undesirable. Although the sequence of events may be possible (each transition occurring with some probability), this type of argument assumes that every transition is inevitable while providing no evidence in support of that. This fallacy plays on the fears of an audience and is related to a number of other fallacies, such as *the appeal to fear*, *false dilemma*, and *the argument from consequences*.

11. Which of the following provides a typical example of *slippery slope*?

A) Medical student: "No one objects to a physician looking up a difficult case in medical books. Why, then, shouldn't students taking a difficult examination be permitted to use their textbooks?"

B) Today late for ten minutes, tomorrow late for an hour, and then someday you will simply cease to show up.

C) Most of my friends say they stopped thinking about philosophy the minute they got through the semester, so I know this class is worthless.

D) Happiness is the highest good for a human being, since all other values are inferior to it.

Question 12 (Suggested completion time: 5 minutes)

Directions: Look at the following picture and then answer the question.

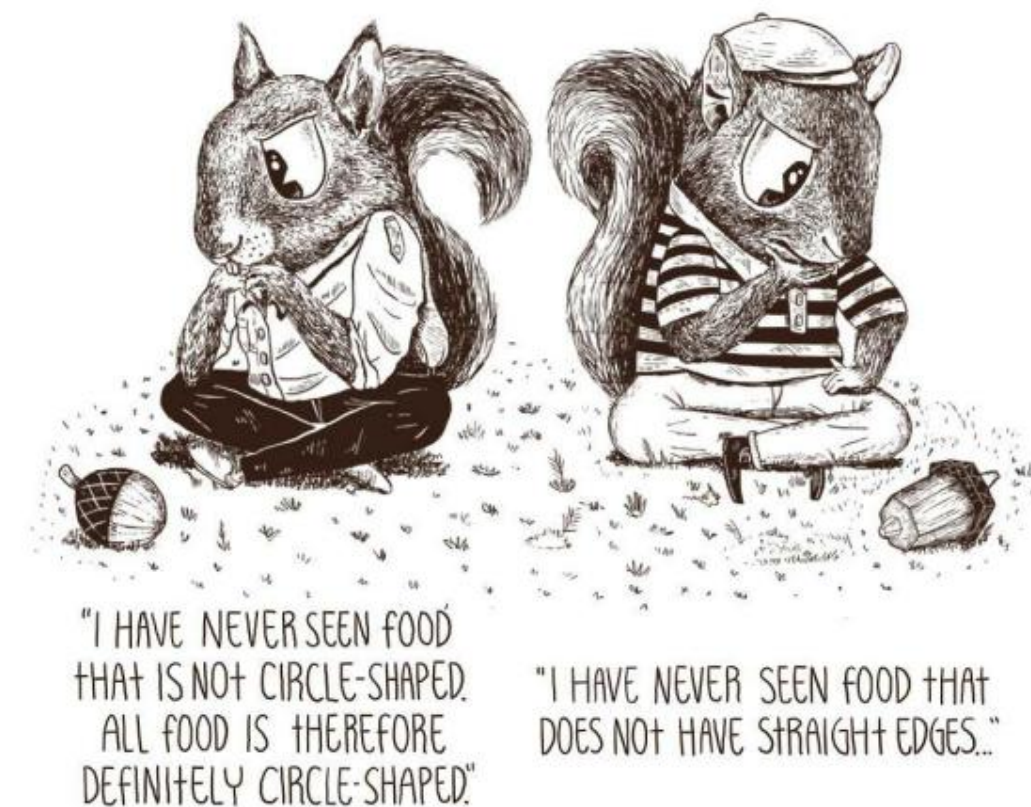
12. Which of the following logical fallacies does the picture illustrate?

A) *No True Scotsman*: an argument coming up after someone has made a general claim about a group of things and then been presented with evidence challenging that claim

B) *Hasty Generalization*: a fallacy committed when one forms a conclusion from a sample that is either too small or too special to be representative

C) *Guilt by Association*: a fallacy used to discredit an argument for proposing an idea that is shared by some socially demonized individual or group

D) *False Dilemma*: an argument that presents a limited set of two possible categories and assumes that everything in the scope of the discussion must be an element of that set



Questions 13-14 Challenge your brain. (Suggested completion time: 5 minutes)

Question 13

Directions: The following brain teasers are to sharpen brains. Your goal is to find a third word that is connected or associated with the two words given.

For example: LOCK – PIANO key

13. EGYPTIAN – MOTHER

Question 14

Directions: *Read the following text and answer the question according to the text.*

Anderson, Biggs, and Carpenter were staying together at a place by the seaside. One day they went out in a boat and were a mile at sea when a rifle was fired on shore in their direction. It seems that Anderson only heard the report of the gun, Biggs only saw the smoke, and Carpenter merely saw the bullet strike the water near them.

14. Which of them first knew of the discharge of the rifle?

A) Carpenter B) Biggs C) Anderson

Questions 15-17 (Suggested completion time: 7 minutes)

Directions: *Read the text about the toco toucan and answer the questions according to the text.*

Measuring 63.5 cm (25 in.) in length, the toco toucan is the largest of all toucans. Its black body and white throat are overshadowed by its most recognizable trait: a large colorful beak.

The bright orange beak is about 19 cm (8 in.) long—one third of the bird's total length. But despite its substantial size, the beak weighs less than you may think. Composed of the protein keratin, the structure of beak incorporates many air pockets allowing for a very low mass.

Furthermore, recent research has concluded that toucans regulate body temperature by adjusting the flow of blood to their beak. More blood flow means more heat is released. When toucans sleep, they tuck their beak under their feathers to keep them warm.

Toco toucans also use their beaks to pluck and peel fruit, their main source of food. In addition, the beak houses a flat tongue of the same length, which helps the toucan catch insects, frogs, and reptiles. Toco toucans also occasionally eat the eggs of other birds.

Although they spend a lot of time in trees, they are not very good at flying. Toucans mainly travel among trees by hopping. When they do take flight, they flap their wings vigorously and glide, traveling only short distances.

Toucans nest in the hollows of trees. They often move into **cavities** created and abandoned by woodpeckers.

Several toucans live together in a single hollow. It is in these hollows that they lay their eggs, generally two to four a year. Both parents incubate the eggs for 16-20 days. Once the chicks hatch, both parents continue to care for the young. Baby toucans are not born with an excessively large beak; their beaks grow as the birds develop.

15. Which of the following pictures is a toco toucan according to the text?



16. Which of the following descriptions is NOT true about toco toucans' beaks?

A) Toco toucans can remove the skin from the fruit with their beak.

C) The beak is composed of many air pockets which lower its weight.

B) A high mass means the beaks containing sufficient protein keratin.

D) Toco toucans use their beaks as a radiator to remove heat from their blood.

17. The word **cavities** in Paragraph 6 is closest in meaning to _____.

A) branches B) nests C) hollows D) hatches

Question 18 (Suggested completion time: 5 minutes)

Directions: Read the text about a famous experiment in history, and answer the question according to the text.

The Milgram Experiment

Humans could be trained to take directions from authority figures. An experiment conducted in 1961 by Yale University psychologist Stanley Milgram measured this willingness to obey authority figures by instructing people to perform acts that conflicted with their morals. Participants were told to play the role of "teacher" and administer electric shocks to "the learner," who was supposedly in a different room, every time they answered a question incorrectly. In reality, no one was actually being shocked. Instead, Milgram played recordings to make it sound

like the learner was in a great deal of pain and wanted to end the experiment. Despite these protests, many participants continued the experiment when the authority figure urged them to, increasing the voltage after each wrong answer until some eventually administered what would be lethal electric shocks. Similar experiments conducted since the original have provided nearly identical results, indicating that people are willing to go against their consciences if they are being told to do so by authority figures.

18. According to the text, we can know that the “teacher” ____.

- | | |
|-----------------------------|-----------------------------------|
| A) was from Yale University | C) was the experiment subject |
| B) didn’t administer shocks | D) acted as the authority figures |

Questions 19-21 (Suggested completion time: 7 minutes)

Directions: *Read the text about a science discovery, and answer the questions according to the text.*

Language & Personality

If you overheard a conversation on a bus, do you think you could tell, from the words that were used and the topics discussed, the personality of the people who were chatting? What about if I showed you a short story? Could you glean something about the character of the author from their language?

We’re often reminded “choose your words carefully” —it turns out the words themselves may reveal far more than what we’re actually trying to say. There’s mounting evidence that our personality is written, quite literally, in the language that we use, from the tweets we send to our choice of email address.

Not all findings are particularly surprising. Those who score highly on extroversion really are a lot louder and chattier than their more introverted peers. They also tend to speak more quickly. Female extroverts, but not males, are more likely to have group chats, while introvert men (but not women) spend more time talking to themselves.

Introverts and extroverts also use language very differently. A few years ago, a group of researchers led by Camiel Beukeboom at VU University, Amsterdam, asked a group of 40 volunteers to look at photos of different social situations and describe out loud what was going on. They found that extroverts' language tended to be more abstract and “loose”, while introverts spoke in more concrete terms. In other words, introverts tend to be a lot more specific.

In line with this, other research has found that introverts tend to use more articles (“the” / “a”)—which, by definition, refer to individual objects or events. They also tend to be more cautious in their language: that is, they use more hedging (“perhaps” , “maybe”), and more quantifiable terms, such as referring to specific numbers.

All of this makes psychological sense. Most extroverts enjoy the fast life, being more likely to drink, sleep around and take risks than introverts; every time they open their mouths, too, extroverts are prepared to take greater risks with the accuracy, spontaneity and reach of what they say.

The links between personality and language also extend to the written word. When Jacob Hirsh and Jordan Peterson from the University of Toronto asked students to write about past experiences and future goals, they found that those who scored higher in extroversion tended to make more mention of words pertaining to relationships, which makes sense, the researchers said, as extroverts are “active social explorers” .

But it’ s not just about extroversion vs introversion. Their language also revealed other aspects of their personalities—including how open-minded they were (the liberal used more words pertaining to the senses), how neurotic (the highly strung referred more often to emotional angst) and how conscientious (more diligent students used more achievement and work-related words).

19. Tweets can reveal more information about personality than emails.

- A) True B) False

20. Extroverts would say: “This article is excellent” rather than “This article is very informative” .

- A) True B) False

21. According to the text, the correct order of the statements should be_____ .

1). The open-minded say:	a. “We can work on it.”	A) 1). a; 2). c; 3). b
2). The neurotic say:	b. “You just need to be heard.”	B) 1). b; 2). c; 3). a
3). The conscientious say:	c. “I carry around a monstrous sadness.”	C) 1). b; 2). a; 3). c
		D) 1). c; 2). a; 3). b

Questions 22-23 (Suggested completion time: 6 minutes)

Directions: Read the text about drones and answer the questions according to the text.

Drones Are Everywhere Now
But How Did They Get Their Name?

When did unmanned aircraft become known as drones? It was probably earlier than you think.

Unmanned aerial vehicles (UAV) were used during World War II as targets for fighters and antiaircraft guns, which had to have something to practice with. These radio-controlled aircraft were called RPVs, or “remotely piloted vehicles,” but their military creators and users soon gave up the acronym for something a little more prosaic.

There were two meanings for “drone” then: a “male bee,” or a “monotonous, sustained sound.” 22

The aircraft’s function can clue you in: it’s an extension of the “bee” meaning. Drones are bigger and heavier than worker bees, and they leave the hive and swarm in the fall. They are renowned for a sort of mindless, driven existence: they don’t gather honey, they don’t defend or maintain the hive, and their only purpose is to impregnate a queen bee.

Using “drone” for the RPVs emphasized the fact that they had no mind of their own. And no doubt the buzzing flight of an RPV also reminded them of another flying buzzer.

The word “drone” was first used of an UAV in 1946, but advances in drone technology in the past few years have made the term much more common. And while they may have no mind of their own, they may soon be connected to yours and be controlled by brainwaves.

22. Which of the following best fits in the numbered space in Paragraph 3?

- | | |
|--|---|
| A) But one meaning is distinct from the other. | C) Which was the inspiration for applying the term? |
| B) Both of the meanings have been constantly used. | D) The term “drone” becomes the ideal choice. |

23. From the text, we can know that _____.

- | | |
|---|---|
| A) the design of drones resembles worker bees | C) human brainwaves will help drones to “think” |
| B) drones could be auto-controlled in the near future | D) the popularity of drones is largely due to their novelty |

Questions 24-31 (Suggested completion time: 30 minutes)

Directions: *Read three passages about the sharing economy. Answer the questions according to the passages.*

Passage A

Bike-sharing startups in China sport a parade of colorful branding for their nifty-looking bikes—orange for Mobike and yellow for ofo, to name two market leaders among some 30 companies that have jumped into this sector. The race is on for dominance just as it has been with taxi-hailing services.

Mobike has drawn more than \$300 million from Temasek, Hillhouse Capital, Sequoia Capital and Tencent’s Xuanwu Lab. ofo, its chief rival, has attracted \$450 million from Didi Chuxing and DST—not to mention a plug by Apple CEO Tim Cook, who recently visited and rode a bike at ofo.

You might say, bike sharing is nothing all that new or exciting. After all, bike-sharing services have popped up in New York City and London.

But the business model and technology for bike sharing in China is more advanced than in the West—one more sign of that skillful Chinese micro-innovating gene. In China, you can drop your rented bike wherever you want to instead of at an assigned docking station—thanks to GPS technology that locates and tracks the position for each bicycle.

In Beijing and Shanghai, bikes are being dropped randomly at street corners, subway stations, campuses, restaurants, shopping malls and you name it. These branded bikes are starting to crowd city sidewalks so much now that talk is that government regulations could be coming to control parking of the bikes only in authorized specific zones.

Just as with Uber and Didi, you can bet that this new startup craze will see price wars and battles to the finish to win—whether it's an acquisition or an IPO (initial public offering: a company's first stock offering to the public). Already, these bike-sharing entrants are trying out new business tactics to tackle some of the challenges of bike-sharing efficiency.

On a panel I moderated recently at Peking University, Mobike CTO (Chief Technology Officer) and co-founder Joe Xia said the company is having initial success with a recently introduced red packet promotion that rewards bikers for returning their bikes to a designated parking spot. Clever!

The bike-sharing services are starting to go global too—at least where flat landscapes and city density makes bicycles a popular form of transportation. Mobike is venturing outside China by entering the Singapore market. To be sure, Mobike does not have an open road—it will compete with Singapore's own O Bike, as other Asian markets begin to adapt this new startup trend.

Passage B

Most sharing economy websites advertise their green credentials, and many users care about their ecological impact. The ecological benefits of sharing are often seen as obvious: secondary markets reduce demand for new goods, so footprints go down. Staying in existing homes reduces the demand for new hotels just as tool-sharing reduces new tool purchases. However, despite the widespread belief that the sector helps to reduce carbon emissions, there are almost no comprehensive studies of its impact. At this point, they are long overdue.

An exception is a recent study of car-sharing. It found a measurable reduction in greenhouse gas emissions, but only because of substantial reductions from a small fraction of households. For the majority, car-sharing, by expanding access to cars, increased emissions.

The ordinary assumptions about ecological impacts are generally about the first, visible shifts made by a consumer—purchasing used products rather than new ones, or staying in a private home rather than a hotel. To assess overall ecological impacts, however, we have to consider ripple effects. What does the seller or the host do with the money earned? She may use the money to buy high-impact products. Does the appearance of a market for used goods lead people to buy more new things that they intend to sell later? If travel becomes less expensive, do people do more of it? All of these effects raise ecological and carbon footprints.

There is also the question of impacts at the level of the economy as a whole. The platforms are creating new markets that expand the volume of commerce and boost purchasing power. The larger, for-profit companies are claiming to generate substantial business and income for their providers. If so, they are likely to create economic activity that would not have existed

otherwise—more travel, more private automobile rides—and not just shifting purchasing from one type of provider to another. My students and I have found that Airbnb users are taking more trips now and that the availability of cheap ride services is diverting some people from public transportation. That means the platforms result in higher carbon emissions, because their services use energy. The companies can't have it both ways—creating new economic activity and reducing carbon emissions—because the two are closely linked.

Passage C

The uniqueness of the sharing economy poses several new challenges for regulators in countries across the world. The inherent objective of regulating such sectors is to encourage competition that will eventually lead to innovation, lower costs, and better products and services.

Regulators are inherently reactive, and very slow to respond to changes in the sharing economy. ____28____

In the digital age, technological advancements bring increasing efficiency. However, existing regulatory organizing bodies lack coordination between the different levels of the government. The lack of a collaborative system results in confused mixes of policies that trickle down through official levels. One such example is Uber being branded as an illegal “bandit taxi-service” in the city of Ottawa. Municipal employees are not provided reimbursement if travelling by an Uber, even though their travel allowance covers licensed taxis. In the Canadian federal government, policy responses are not yet concrete even though they are aware that their own employees take Uber to get to work. Political parties have not identified an approach to regulating the sharing economy.

In India, the High Court of Delhi has asked the government of India to develop guidelines for regulating taxi cab aggregators. This is an important exercise which needs to be based on real world data and also needs a simple enforcement mechanism. The more stringent the regulatory guidelines, the higher the regulatory capacity must be to monitor and enforce these guidelines.

Regulation should only be changed when there is an immediate need, such as market failure. There is no such need for the sharing economy.

Commercial activities in the sharing economy blur lines between the personal and professional. For example, most Airbnb hosts are not professional hoteliers, and a large fraction of Lyft and Uber drivers are not professional drivers and are only active on the platform fewer than fifteen hours per week. Applying a regulatory regime to these businesses might create an entry barrier. Absence of regulations, on the other hand, can lead to more part-time supply and that forms part of a self-regulatory solution.

24. According to Passage A, what makes the bike sharing in China different from the West?

- | | |
|---|--|
| A) No assigned docking station is needed. | C) The number of bikes is enormous. |
| B) It is very cheap to rent a bike. | D) The bikes are attractive in appearance. |

25. What kind of attitude does the author have towards the red packet promotion introduced by Mobike in Passage A?

A) Critical. B) Favorable. C) Ambivalent. D) Skeptical.

26. It can be inferred from Passage B that car-sharing business may increase carbon emissions because _____.

A) more cars will be purchased
B) people will travel a lot more
C) private cars will be used more
D) taxi drivers will work longer hours

27. The author of Passage B holds the following views EXCEPT that_____.

A) carbon emission will be increased by sharing economy
B) more comprehensive studies should have been done
C) sharing economy has created more economic activities
D) most people overlook the impact of sharing economy

28. Which of the following best fits in the numbered space in Passage C?

A) They find it unnecessary.
B) They play a catch-up role.
C) They are reluctant to do so.
D) They need more data.

29. According to Passage C, we can infer that the regulation the sharing economy needs should _____.

A) establish entry barriers
B) encourage competition
C) quickly respond to changes
D) create more part-time jobs

30. Which of the following types of sharing economy is mentioned in all three passages?

A) tool sharing B) home sharing C) car sharing D) bike sharing

31. Which of the following statements about sharing economy is TRUE according to the three passages?

A) China has become a leading country in sharing economy.
B) Authority regulations are badly needed for sharing economy.
C) Sharing economy brings about challenges as well as chances.
D) Uber, Airbnb and Mobike have been successful worldwide.